What is a CV:

A Curriculum Vitae or CV is a Latin phrase meaning, 'course of life'. Sometimes our Assessors may ask you to supply a CV this is so that we can see what other skills and experience you have in your chosen field of expertise. Our assessors will ask for your CV if they feel that the activity application lacks the necessary evidence of the person who has written the learning material or of the person who is delivering the training, for example if you only recently achieved your certificate then the assessors may ask to see further evidence of your skills and experience. Do not be offended if you are asked to upload your CV or a Resume for further evidence, our assessors just want to make sure that the person(s) writing or delivering the training have the right level of knowledge and understanding of the subject.

Your CV should list your academic achievements, employment history, hobbies, interests and references. Start with listing the most recent work experience and work backwards to the first. Your employment history should tell the reader how long you worked at each place of employment, what your job title was, and what your role and responsibilities were during your time there.

If you are self-employed then you will still need to list the date you started your company/business – present and what your role and responsibilities are, whether you employ people or not and reasons for becoming self-employed. Did you leave a job because you were unsatisfied with what was expected of you? What do you enjoy most about running your own business?

A CV will usually have an opening statement which gives an insight into the type of person you are. This can either be written in the first person or the third person. This should be a few sentences and an opportunity to tell your prospective employer the reasons why you are the most suitable candidate for the job.

If you have had lots of different employment experiences, we suggest only listing those work experiences that are relevant to the subject matter that you are writing or trying to get accredited or perhaps write up a Resume instead. Alternatively, you may only want to list the last 10 – 15yrs of work experience, especially if you have been in a job for a long time.

What to include on a CV

- Personal details – name, address contact details and a head shot.
- Opening statement
- Educational establishments (from GCSE age upwards)
- Educational achievements (GCSE's, A 'levels, Degrees)
- Places of employment
- Other achievements and accomplishments. – this is your opportunity to shout about your achievements and accolades during your time with any employer. Did you get promoted? Did you introduce a new system? What did you do that helped you and your fellow colleagues make working better? What did you bring to the company during your time with them? Did you increase sales, turnover or distribution?
- Other certificates – this can include CPD achievements, or courses that you have completed for your own interest.

- Hobbies and interests
- References

What is a Resume:

A Resume is shorter and communicates your most recent and relevant work experience history, unlike a CV which is longer and more relevant to academic achievements. You should avoid adding too much information and focus on what your responsibilities were rather than any results driven achievements.

What to include on a Resume:

- Name / contact email and phone number.
- Head shot / opening statement
- List your education
- Skills and certifications
- List of employment & job title / from and to /
- Bullet point your role and responsibilities for each job
- Any other achievements and accomplishments – eg, CPD certificates
- Hobbies and interests

What Not to put on your CV or Resume:

- Unprofessional email address.
- An old phone number – ensure that you have the most recent and up to date number
- Irrelevant work experience
- Salary
- Referee's details
- Photographs (only a head shot)
- Grammatical errors
- Age
- Lies – with social media and the internet it is easy for employers to find information about you, especially if they suspect that you are lying during the interview process.

Facebook, Instagram and Websites:

Most employers will do some background research into you, so be careful what you put on social media, however if you are running your own business then it is a good idea to include the links to your business pages and/or website so that prospective employers get a feel for your business and can also see how active you are on social media.

Your CV or Resume is a reflection of you, so it is important that it is presented professionally, especially if you are applying for a job.

Ideally a CV shouldn't be more than 3 - 4 pages whereas a Resume is usually only 1 – 2 sides and is an overview of your relevant work experience.

Please see our examples of a CV and a Resume – these are also editable for you to use. Alternatively, you can download examples from other websites and if you have a Canva Account you can also create your own from a variety of different templates.